Spradling Group eXp REALTY

POWERED BY

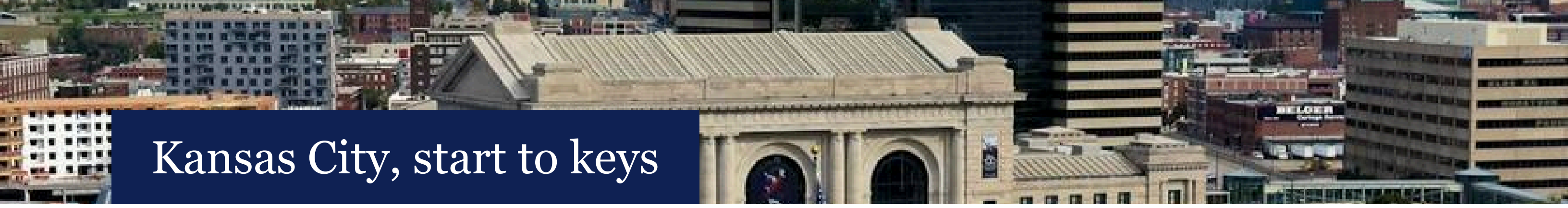
HouseLoop

FROM SEARCHING TO *home*

THE BUYER'S GUIDE

THE SPRADLING GROUP

REAL TRENDS TOP 10 TEAM IN KANSAS · 913-320-0906 · HOUSELOOP.AI



THE WHOLE THING ON ONE PAGE

Six steps from *hello* to keys

Most of buying a house is process, and we run it for you. **Step four** decides whether you actually get the house — and the rest of this guide is about that one step.

1 **We sit down together**
Must-haves, budget, neighborhoods — and we sign a Buyer's Agency Agreement.

2 **You get fully underwritten**
Not pre-approved — **underwritten**. Your loan is effectively finished before you ever find a house. Free, almost nobody does it, and it's the largest advantage you'll carry into an offer.

3 **You see homes first**
New listings reach you the moment they go live, often before the public sites. Text us an address and a time; we meet you there.

4 **We write the offer that wins**
You found it — and so did four other families that afternoon. **Everything after this page is this one step.**

5 **Under contract**
Inspection, appraisal, lender, title, walkthrough. Your coordinator tracks every date; you hear from us *before* each one, not after it slipped.

6 **Keys — and we're still here**
Vendors, values and questions years later — we measure this by the relationship.

> *“They were able to answer all of our questions and provided clear communication, making us feel confident through the* ***entire home buying process****.”*
>
> ★★★★★ JONATHAN D.

The highest offer *does not* win

Five offers on the same $400,000 house, spread across a seller's kitchen counter on a Sunday night. Watch what happens when they read past the top line.

OFFER	PRICE	CLOSE	INSPECTION	EARNEST	GAP
Buyer A	$412,000	30 days	Full + repairs	$4,000	None
Buyer B	$408,000	30 days	Full	$4,000	None
Buyer C	**$409,000**	**10 days**	**As-is, inspects**	**$12,000 firm**	**$10,000**
Buyer D	$405,000 cash	10 days	Waived	$5,000	N/A
Buyer E	$415,000	45 days	Full + credits	$2,000	None

BUYER E OFFERED THE MOST — AND LOST

$415,000 looks like the winner until the seller reads the rest: 45 days of waiting, a repair negotiation coming, only $2,000 at risk, and a request that they pay the buyer's costs. Their real net is *lower* and the risk is higher.

BUYER C WON AT $409,000

Six thousand below the top offer. Buyer C didn't outbid anybody — they **out-structured** everybody: fastest close, no repair fight, real money committed, appraisal risk lifted off the seller entirely.

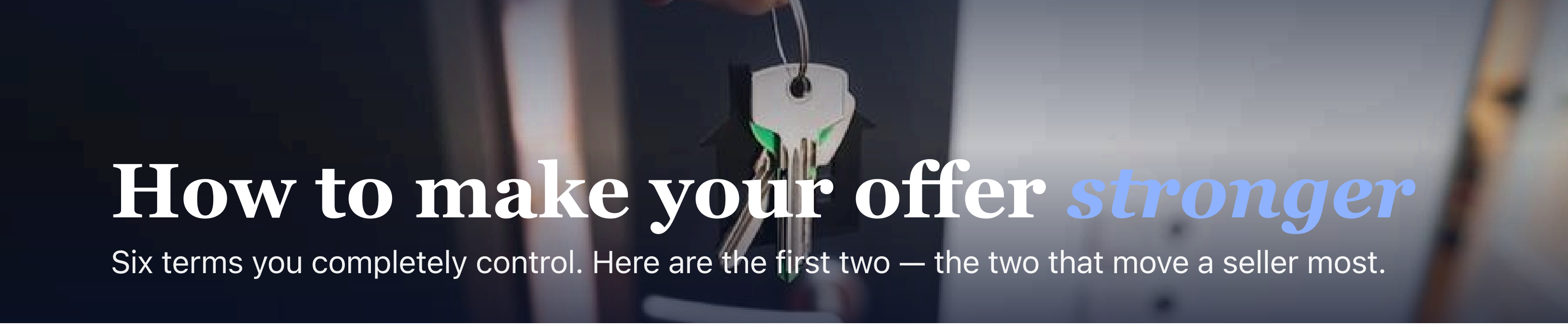
PRICE IS THE ONE THING EVERY OTHER BUYER IS ALREADY COMPETING ON. THESE SIX AREN'T.

How fast you close • How you handle the inspection • Whether you escalate • How much you put at risk • Who covers the appraisal gap • Who pays whose closing costs

> *“In this insane market we got a house on our **first offer** — up against **36 other offers**. The Spradling Group coached us well on what we needed to do to be competitive.”*

★★★★★

ALLY L.



How to make your offer *stronger*

Six terms you completely control. Here are the first two — the two that move a seller most.

Close *faster*

A normal financed purchase closes in about thirty days. Cash closes in seven to ten — and that speed, not the cash, is usually what the seller is buying. If you were underwritten in step two, you can offer it too.

STANDARD

30 days

The normal financed timeline. Underwriting happens after you're already under contract.

STRONGER

21 days

Tight but realistic with a responsive local lender who answers the phone.

STRONGEST

10 days

Only possible if you were fully underwritten *before* you found the house.

WHAT THE SELLER HEARS

"I can be out of this house and into my next one in a week and a half." Sellers are almost always buying something else — your closing date is *their* moving date. Cost to you: a few hours of paperwork.

Handle the *inspection* deliberately

The seller's biggest fear is a contract that unravels three weeks later over a repair list. Three ways to answer it — the middle one is where most of our buyers land.

TRADITIONAL

Full inspection

Ten-day period, you can request repairs or credits, plus about five days to negotiate them.

THE SWEET SPOT

As-is — you still inspect

You won't ask for repairs or credits, but you keep the **full right to inspect** and **the right to cancel**.

RARELY RECOMMENDED

Waive inspections

None at all. Strongest position, by far the most risk — nobody has looked at the furnace, roof or foundation.

> *"They gave us **great advice on how to put in a competitive offer**, which helped us purchase our first home."*
>
> MIRANDA K.

Beat the next offer *automatically*

An escalation clause says: *I'll pay a set amount above the highest competing offer, up to a maximum I choose*. The house asks **$300,000**; you offer $300,000, beating any higher offer by **$2,000**, capped at **$335,000**.

WHAT HAPPENS	YOU PAY	WHY
Nobody else offers	**$300,000**	The clause never fires. Costs you nothing.
Someone offers $310,000	**$312,000**	You escalate and win — no counter round.
Someone offers $334,000	**You stop**	$336,000 breaks your ceiling. It holds.

DECIDE THREE NUMBERS BEFORE YOU SIGN ONE

Your **starting** offer · how much you beat a competing offer **by** · your **maximum**. In a competitive market $2,500–$5,000 rarely moves anything; **$15,000–$25,000** is where houses change hands. And make it $15,700, not $15,000 — non-round numbers stop looking like a guess.

Put real money *at risk*

Earnest money runs about 1% of the price — the clearest signal you can send that you intend to close, because it's the only one that costs you something if you don't.

HOW IT ACTUALLY WORKS

- It is **credited back to you at closing**. Not an extra cost of buying.
- Cancel under a contingency and it's returned — **but never automatically**. Both parties sign a release telling title how to disburse it.

WHY NON-REFUNDABLE WINS

It tells the seller: *if I walk for any reason other than a contingency, I lose real money.* A promise with teeth — and it costs you nothing if you close, because **it is still fully credited**.

> *"Their guidance during negotiations gave me options and answered every question* ***with facts****. I followed their lead and I bought the house."*
>
> ★★★★★ JIM L.

Take the *appraisal risk* off the table

If the home appraises below the purchase price, your lender lends against the **appraised value**, not what you agreed to pay. Somebody covers the difference — and the seller is quietly wondering whether it's them. You agree to **$410,000**, it appraises at **$400,000**, and that **$10,000 gap** becomes a negotiation: you pay it, they drop the price, or the deal dies.

STANDARD

No coverage

Renegotiate or walk if it appraises low. Perfectly fine in a slower market.

STRONGER

Cover up to a set amount

$5,000 · $10,000 · whatever you genuinely have sitting there.

STRONGEST

Cover the whole gap

The appraisal stops being the seller's problem entirely.

BE HONEST WITH YOURSELF ON THIS ONE

Gap coverage is paid **in cash, out of pocket, on top of your down payment**. Only ever offer what you actually have — we would rather lose a house than put you in a corner at the closing table.

The seller reads *net*, not price

Two offers at the same number are not the same offer. Every dollar you ask a seller to contribute comes straight off what they walk away with, and they do that math immediately.

PAY YOUR OWN CLOSING COSTS

Asking the seller to help with closing costs is common, and in a slow market it's smart. In a competitive one it quietly lowers your offer: **$410,000 asking for $10,000 in credits is a $400,000 offer** — exactly how it reads on the counter.

OR HELP WITH THEIRS

Some buyers contribute **$1,500–$5,000** toward the **seller's** costs. It can win a house **without raising your purchase price** — which matters, because price has to appraise and a contribution doesn't.

> *"When we thought we might lose the house, they were there every step of the way to give us comfort and **our best chance at fighting for it**."*

★★★★★

BEVERLY D.

PUTTING THE SIX TOGETHER

Not every strategy is right for *every buyer*

The strongest offers stack several of these terms at once. But stacking all six isn't bravery — it's how people end up in houses they regret. Here is what three real buyers might do on the exact same house, on the same Sunday night.

CAREFUL

First home, savings are tight, needs the inspection to sleep at night.

- 21-day close
- Full inspection
- 1% earnest money
- No appraisal gap coverage
- Pays their own closing costs

> Competitive without exposure. Loses to a stronger offer sometimes — and that is a completely acceptable outcome.

BALANCED — MOST BUYERS

Underwritten, has some reserves, genuinely wants this house.

- **10-day close**
- **As-is, still inspects**
- Escalation to a firm maximum
- 2–3% earnest money
- Covers a $10,000 appraisal gap

> Beats most offers on the counter, including plenty of cash ones. Keeps every right to walk away.

AGGRESSIVE

Strong reserves, has already lost houses, knows exactly what they're taking on.

- 10-day close
- Waives inspection
- Non-refundable earnest money
- Covers the full gap
- Helps with the seller's costs

> Very hard to beat. Also the most ways to get hurt, and we will say so out loud before you sign it.

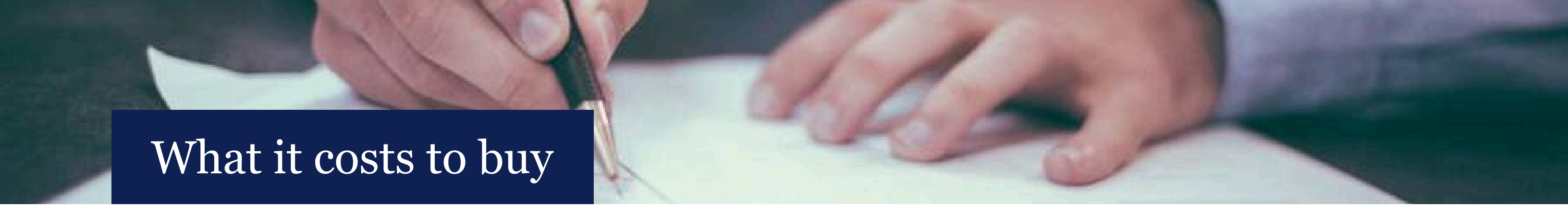
WHAT OUR JOB ACTUALLY IS

Not to hand you the most aggressive offer on this page — to help you work out **which of these three you actually are**, then execute it better than anyone else at the table. Every term answers one silent question: *how much of this deal's risk are you taking off me?* Price is what you pay. The other five are what you promise. Sellers choose promises.

> *"They were incredibly responsive and patient, and helped us **feel comfortable with every offer we put in.**"*

★★★★★

JACQUELINE S.



What it costs to buy

THE MONEY

Beyond the *down payment*

Closing costs generally run **2–4% of the purchase price**. Here is exactly what sits inside that number, so that none of it is a surprise the week you close.

LINE ITEM	WHAT IT ACTUALLY COVERS
Loan origination	The lender's charge for creating your loan.
Discount points	Optional — money paid up front to buy your interest rate down.
Appraisal fee	The independent valuation your lender requires before funding.
Prepaid interest	Interest covering the days from closing to the end of that month.
Title search	Confirms the seller can legally sell it and nobody else has a claim.
Title insurance	Protects you if a claim on the property surfaces years later.
Recording fees	What the county charges to record the deed in your name.
Survey	Establishes exactly where the property boundaries sit.
Flat fee	$495 — disclosed to you up front, never at the table.

ALSO DUE AT CLOSING — BUT NOT A FEE

Prepaid homeowners insurance and property taxes. These are your own expenses paid ahead of time; you would owe them whether you financed the house or paid cash for it.

SOMETHING WORTH REMEMBERING

Every real estate transaction has costs. The question was never whether you'd pay them — it's whether you knew in advance. **We hand you a written estimate before you write an offer.**

> *"As a first home purchase they were so kind and helpful, and **very quick and responsive** the whole way through."*
>
> ★★★★★
>
> MIKAILA E.

What happens *next*

Three things, and then we go to work. Everything else in this guide, we handle for you.

1 Decide to work together

We sign a Buyer's Agency Agreement. It says we represent **you** — your interests, your information, your negotiation. It is how representation legally begins and what lets us go to work on your behalf.

2 Get underwritten by John Nelson

John Nelson · Fountain Mortgage · 913-608-7029 · 7501 Mission Road #200, Prairie Village, KS 66208. A respected local team with some of the lowest rates and closing costs we see, who have closed hundreds of our buyers. **Ask John to fully underwrite you**, not just pre-approve — that one request is the first term on the list, it's free, and it's the reason a financed buyer can beat cash.

3 Start touring

Preview the homes we send through your search portal. Text or call with an address and when you'd like to see it, and we'll meet you there — evenings and weekends included. When you fall in love with one, we write the offer that same day, with the terms that fit *you* and not somebody else. That's the conversation the last six pages were preparing you for, and by then you'll already know which of the three offers on page seven is yours.

ONE THING WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU GO TO AN OPEN HOUSE

In most transactions there are two agents, and only one of them works for you. Calling the listing agent directly does not get you a better deal — it gets you the **seller's advocate on both sides of the table**, at the exact moment you most need somebody on yours.

QUESTIONS BETWEEN NOW AND THEN

Call or text **913-320-0906** — day or night. There is genuinely no such thing as a question too small to ask before you spend this much money.

> *“Super helpful in finding listings we loved, and when we decided on one they were **quick and thorough** in getting most everything we wanted.”*

★★★★★

ALEX T.

DON'T TAKE OUR WORD FOR IT

642 five-star reviews

484 on Zillow, 158 on Google, both averaging a perfect 5.0. Every voice here is a **buyer** — somebody we helped *get* a house.

★★★★★

5.0 AVERAGE

642	450	$150M	Top 10
FIVE-STAR REVIEWS	HOMES SOLD	SALES VOLUME	REAL TRENDS KANSAS

*"We got a house on our **first offer** — up against **36 other offers**. **The Spradling Group coached us well** on what we needed to do to be competitive. 10 out of 5 stars."*

★★★★★ ALLY L.

*"As first-time homebuyers we had many questions, but **The Spradling Group** patiently guided us through the entire process with kindness and clarity."*

★★★★★ CATHY & ANDREW D.

*"They sent me listings **before they posted on public platforms**, and pointed out both the bad and the good in homes so I could be confident about my purchase."*

★★★★★ ALEXANDRIA B.

*"We were expecting a long, painful process, but they made everything easy. From house hunting to closing, **everything was seamless**."*

★★★★★ MEGAN N.

*"I was hesitant to even get pre-approval, but felt secure with the team's help. As a **first-time home buyer**, I cannot thank them enough."*

★★★★★ DRAKE S.

*"They went above and beyond to make sure we were happy, and made the whole process of purchasing a house very **smooth and transparent**."*

★★★★★ ZAINAB E.

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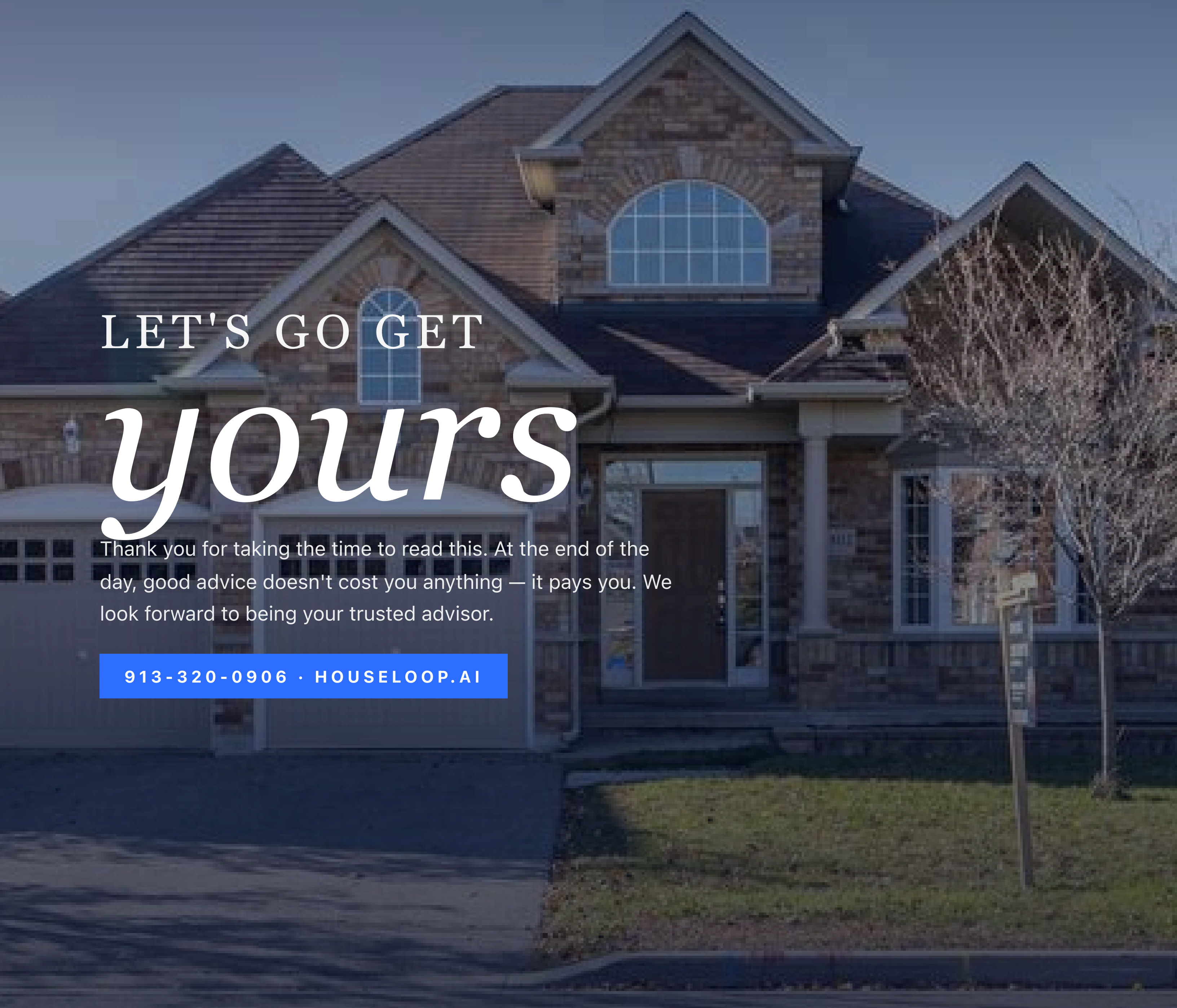

LET'S GO GET *yours*

Thank you for taking the time to read this. At the end of the day, good advice doesn't cost you anything — it pays you. We look forward to being your trusted advisor.

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